

Chapter 150 - Part 1

Liang Shi didn't react at first, only responding dully with an "oh."

Gu Yixue's designated driver had arrived, and she turned to leave. It wasn't until Gu Yixue's car disappeared into the traffic that Liang Shi finally understood what had happened.

Belatedly, she covered her face with both hands.

Ahhhhh!

Just how much had Gu Yixue heard?!

Liang Shi felt like she was being roasted over a fire. It wasn't until the designated driver came over and politely asked, "Hello, are you the one who placed the order?"

Only then did Liang Shi lower her hands, but the driver looked at her in surprise and asked, "Do you have a fever? Should I take you to the hospital?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She gave a light cough, pretending to be serious: "Ah, no."

After saying that, she handed the car keys to the driver and practically fled into the back seat.

The car was a bit warmer than outside, and the residual heat on Liang Shi's body hadn't yet faded.

She hadn't drunk much—she'd only accompanied Gu Yixue with a few glasses since Gu Yixue was drinking alone. It was nowhere near enough to get drunk.

But right now, she inexplicably felt dizzy.

After the driver got in the car, he still seemed hesitant: "Are you sure you don't need to go to the hospital?"

Liang Shi refused: "No need."

Then she took out her phone and sent a message to Xu Qingzhu: 【Someone overheard us just now.】

She knew Xu Qingzhu was sleeping, so she was just venting one-sidedly.

【Our director was also in the stairwell at the time!】

【When she left just now, she told me it's best not to tie people up, that something could go wrong.】

【Babe, I'm dying of embarrassment.】

【How am I supposed to face anyone tomorrow!】

Liang Shi was still typing when Xu Qingzhu's message suddenly popped up: 【Wifey, aren't you joining the crew the day after tomorrow? She has something to do tomorrow.】

Liang Shi: "....."

She suddenly realized what she was doing and started frantically recalling the messages, but Xu Qingzhu sent over a screenshot.

Xu Qingzhu: 【I took a screenshot.】

Liang Shi: 【.....Please leave me some dignity.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【It's legal, so what's the problem?】

Liang Shi: 【.....】

After a moment, Liang Shi changed the subject: 【Why aren't you asleep yet?】

Xu Qingzhu sent a voice message, her voice slightly hoarse and soft: "I was asleep, but my phone was on vibrate. When you messaged, I woke up. Are you not home yet?"

Liang Shi felt like something had suddenly struck her heart. She leaned her head against the car window, her slender fingers poking at the screen: 【Why didn't you turn on Do Not Disturb mode? Don't you usually have it on when you sleep at home?】

"If I turned it on, I wouldn't be able to receive your messages." Xu Qingzhu hadn't fully woken up yet, and her words came out all soft and sweet.

Even through the screen, Liang Shi could imagine her lying in bed with her eyes half-closed, sending messages.

It made one want to ruffle her head.¹

Concerned that there was someone in the front seat, Liang Shi continued typing to her: 【You can read my messages when you wake up. Sleep is more important.】

Xu Qingzhu: "Actually, I'm not that sleepy."

After a while, Xu Qingzhu sent another message: "It was just a bit boring while waiting for you."

Liang Shi: 【.....】

Just now during their video call, there had been obvious dark circles under her eyes—clearly from staying up too late and too often—and she had been on the verge of dozing off.

Liang Shi didn't expose her lie: 【Then sleep a bit more. I'll call you when I get back.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Okay.】

After a while, Xu Qingzhu sent another seven-second voice message. Liang Shi tapped to listen.

In that cool, hoarse voice, she asked in sleepy confusion: "How does Director Gu know that tying people up is bad? Has she tried it before?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She had to admire Xu Qingzhu and her peculiar logic.

Even when she was on the verge of falling asleep, she still remembered these little details.

"Also," Xu Qingzhu sent another voice message, "what was Director Gu doing in the stairwell when we were on the phone? And she eavesdropped on everything."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi paused for a moment, then replied: "Maybe she was on a date with the mysterious jiejie."

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1. "Rua" (Rua一下腦袋) is Chinese internet slang derived from a playful onomatopoeia, meaning to squish, pat, or ruffle something soft and cute, like someone's head or cheeks. It expresses affection and the urge to interact with something adorable. ⇐

Chapter 150 - Part 2

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This matter was only awkward at the very beginning.

Especially right when it had been exposed.

After she got home and chatted with Xu Qingzhu for a while, she didn't feel anything was wrong anymore.

Mainly because she forgot about it.

Because Xu Qingzhu had goaded her with words, making her take out the tie from the closet and cut it up. The scissors were in the drawer of the coffee table in the living room.

Following her instructions, Liang Shi cut it into two strips of different lengths.

Liang Shi said she was wasting things, a reckless waste of resources.

But Xu Qingzhu lay on the bed laughing softly, one arm raised above her head. Her fair wrist was bare—unlike Liang Shi, who occasionally wore small accessories, and was currently wearing the bracelet that Xu Qingzhu had bid on for her before.

Even through the camera, one could clearly see the veins on her wrist.

The lines were very prominent.

Her long hair spread out like seaweed, her fingers slightly curled. Her voice carried a hint of laughter, very soft: "Consider it as being tied up by you."

The black tie that Liang Shi was fiddling with in her hands suddenly felt a bit hot.

Even so, Liang Shi still said coldly: "Stop messing around."

Though she lacked some conviction.

"So you don't like it?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi: "....."

After a moment, unable to keep up the pretense, Liang Shi said quietly: "It's... alright."

Still not very convincing.

Xu Qingzhu smiled and took out a tie from under her pillow.

Liang Shi had seen it before when helping her put away clothes—it was paired with that blue shirt of hers, a professional outfit that was gentle yet sharp.

The color of that tie was on the darker side, but not quite deep black.

It was more like a mix of gray and blue.

The width of the tie was just enough to cover her mouth, creating a strong visual impact.

Liang Shi's throat moved slightly, and she couldn't help but take a screenshot.

It was the kind of casual screenshot that could be used as wallpaper.

"Stop fooling around," Liang Shi said. "Aren't you tired?"

As she spoke, she turned off the bright light in the room, leaving only the dim bedside lamp. She was lying in the spot where Xu Qingzhu usually slept, covered with Xu Qingzhu's blanket.

"I'm okay." Xu Qingzhu took the tie down and casually wound it around her wrist, like a vine wrapping around a tree trunk.

The vivid color contrast made her skin appear even whiter.

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Are you sleepy?"

"I'm okay too," Liang Shi said.

The two of them chatted on and off, and then Xu Qingzhu finally couldn't stay awake any longer. The hand wrapped with the tie was pressed under her head, her hand slowly relaxing. The camera fell face-down on the bed, plunging into darkness.

Liang Shi ended the video call.

Then she tossed the cut-up tie into the drawer.

Chapter 150 - Part 3

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Splash.

Water sprayed several meters high into the air, and the sky-blue water rippled in layers.

It was like falling into the deep sea, sinking all the way down.

The sounds around were noisy, yet she couldn't make out what they were saying.

Her body continued to sink.

Xu Qingzhu felt like she could barely breathe. Her body seemed to no longer belong to her.

And as she suffocated, images flashed before her eyes frame by frame, like a movie playing.

It was Liang Shi holding a knife, pinning her down on the bed, viciously stabbing her body.

Then using that sharp knife to pierce behind her ear.

In an instant, her body experienced bone-piercing pain—so painful she could barely breathe.

She desperately wanted to escape that environment.

But her body was ruthlessly pinned to the bed by Liang Shi. No matter what she did, she couldn't escape.

She couldn't break free, couldn't escape—like a fish on a chopping board, she could only await her impending death.

Pain came from where the knife had stabbed her, and from the gland behind her ear. This pain spread throughout her entire body, giving her that feeling of being unable to live yet unable to die.

Her throat was hoarse and dry. She wanted to cry for help, but nothing came out.

She could only reach out her hand, hoping someone would pull her up.

But all she could see was blood red—the color dyed by her own blood.

Her skirt billowed open in the water, and the blue dress had also been stained with blood.

This state of still being conscious yet completely powerless was too agonizing. She opened her mouth, but only swallowed a stomachful of seawater.

The salty fishiness mixed with the smell of blood.

Liang Shi...

That knife ultimately didn't spare her.

The sharp blade rotated as it carved across every inch behind her ear. The sound of the blade slicing through skin drowned out the sound of the seawater flowing, making one's scalp go numb.

Xu Qingzhu was on the verge of suffocation. The pain in her body was tormenting her. She watched as clumps of blood dissolved into the water.

The color of the water changed from blue to red.

She desperately wanted to shout: "Liang Shi, it's me."

"Jiejie, it's me."

"Wife, wake up."

But those eyes were strange and fierce, showing no mercy as the knife pierced her skin.

Gleaming with bloodlust.

Even crazier than when Chen Liuying had held a knife during the kidnapping.

She watched as her gland was thrown onto the ground.

The pain of having her gland gouged out was a small matter. What hurt her most was that Liang Shi had raised the knife toward her.

That knife fell on her body, showing no mercy whatsoever.

Even carrying the pleasure of revenge.

Xu Qingzhu kept struggling and finally managed to speak: "Wife, what's... wrong with you?"

Liang Shi scoffed lightly, toying with that sharp knife in her hand. When their eyes met, she stabbed the knife straight into her heart.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her in disbelief. "Jiejie..."

"Who's your jiejie, idiot." Liang Shi's voice sounded in her ear, filling her with despair.

Xu Qingzhu reached out trying to touch her, but only grasped at emptiness.

That person had dissolved into the water.

But her voice continued: "Xu Qingzhu, stop pretending to be so high and mighty."

"Didn't you say you don't like me? Then don't like anyone at all."

"What I can't have, I'll just destroy."

"I couldn't bear to touch you, but what about you?"

"Die."

"....."

Sentence after sentence, terrifying to hear.

As if they were voices from hell.

Chapter 150 - Part 4

Xu Qingzhu reached out her hand for help, but still no one came. She closed her eyes in despair.

Her heart ached to the point of numbness.

Just as she was about to die, someone suddenly grabbed her hand. "Xu Qingzhu, hold on."

It was a very clear voice, like jade pieces colliding, sounding very reassuring.

Xu Qingzhu struggled to open her eyes, but could only see emptiness in the water.

Then she was grabbed by someone who desperately pulled her upward.

A speck of light seemed to appear in the dark sky.

She tried hard to see the figure and face of that person, but everything was obscured by a fog.

No matter what, she couldn't see clearly.

"Who are you?" Xu Qingzhu asked hoarsely.

There was no answer.

Xu Qingzhu felt her consciousness fading, but Liang Shi's words still echoed in her ears. In the end, only two words remained: "Die."

Die.

Die.

Like a vicious curse being chanted.

How much hatred must one have for a person to say such things?

Xu Qingzhu didn't understand.

She really wanted to ask—aren't we in love? Why?

But there seemed to be no reason.

She just wanted her to die, that's all.

Xu Qingzhu couldn't bear this kind of blow. She let go of the hand of the person saving her and allowed herself to sink recklessly.

Even she herself thought: Die, just die.

As if she had been bewitched by something.

Her body kept sinking, and she could only hear the person saving her calling out continuously: "Xu Qingzhu, Xu Qingzhu..."

But she couldn't hear anymore.

The boundless water engulfed her aching body.

Where exactly did it hurt?

She couldn't say clearly anymore.

It seemed like her heart hurt more.

That was Liang Shi.

How could that be Liang Shi?

How could this be happening?

What on earth was wrong with this world?

Xu Qingzhu had countless questions, but couldn't get a single answer.

Water flooded into her body...

"Ah." Xu Qingzhu suddenly opened her eyes and sat up.

Her hair was a mess, her head ached terribly. She instinctively reached to touch behind her ear—her gland was still there, but it felt like it had been gouged out.

Her body was also completely unharmed.

So was it all just a dream?

But why would there be such a realistic dream? So realistic that it felt like she had been stabbed several times.

The secretary beside her was trembling with fear. "President Xu."

Xu Qingzhu looked up, her gaze cold. The secretary shivered and immediately said: "You have an appointment with Mr. Robert at nine o'clock. It's time to get up now."

"I know," Xu Qingzhu said.

Then she asked: "Did anyone come into my room last night?"

"No," the secretary answered. "I just came in. Because you didn't answer when I knocked, I thought you had fain—"

The words suddenly stopped as she realized this was rather inauspicious to say.

Xu Qingzhu pressed her temples and lowered her head: "No, I was just sleeping deeply."

"Did you have a nightmare?" the secretary asked. "When I came in, I saw you frowning tightly, like you were very uncomfortable."

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment. "Sort of."

In fact, it was an extremely terrifying dream.

In the dream, her gland had been gouged out by Liang Shi, and Liang Shi had also left many wounds on her body.

It was nothing like the Liang Shi she knew.

Rather, it resembled the one from before.

But the most terrifying part was that no one answered when she called for help.

Even though it had happened in a dream, when Xu Qingzhu touched the places where she had been injured in the dream, there was a faint burning sensation.

It made one feel that this wasn't a dream, but something that had actually happened.

Seeing her low mood, the secretary didn't dare disturb her much and just stood quietly by the bed, waiting for her to recover.

But Xu Qingzhu irritably ran a hand through her hair and picked up her phone from the bedside.

After unlocking it, she found the screen was still on the chat window with Liang Shi, showing that the two of them had video chatted for 30 minutes last night.

Chapter 150 - Part 5

Xu Qingzhu lowered her eyes and typed in the chat box: 【I just had a nightmare.】

Her finger was already hovering over the send button, but in the end she changed her mind and quickly deleted all the words.

She truly felt that it wasn't a dream—it felt exactly like something that would actually happen.

And it was this Liang Shi.

Her heart felt like it was being struck by something, aching and sour.

A thought abruptly popped into her mind: Leave her. You two won't be happy together.

Xu Qingzhu's mood was extremely terrible.

She tried to push away this awful feeling, but found it was futile.

Her heart just kept aching like this.

She endured the pain and went to meet Mr. Robert to discuss expanding into overseas markets.

When meeting Mr. Robert, she was also forcing a smile, which was seen through by the other party at a glance. "Miss Xu, do you have something on your mind?"

Xu Qingzhu paused for a moment, then asked in fluent English: "Sir, if your spouse wanted to kill you, what would you do?"

This question stunned the fifty-something Robert. After a moment, he said: "Miss Xu, you really know how to joke."

"This is not a joke," Xu Qingzhu said. "I feel like my wife wants to kill me."

Since this morning, this feeling had been extraordinarily strong.

"Then..." Robert, hearing this, also answered her seriously, "Before she kills me, I'd kill her first."

Xu Qingzhu lowered her eyes, feeling like a heavy stone was pressing on her heart. "Never mind."

She had gotten pitifully little sleep last night—the time difference with Liang Shi's side was too great.

After meeting Mr. Robert, she returned to the hotel to catch up on sleep.

But she hadn't slept long before that dream struck again.

It was shorter than last night's, but the pain intensified.

Xu Qingzhu was literally jolted awake by the pain, waking up drenched in cold sweat.

Without a word, she called Liang Shi.

It was morning on Liang Shi's side, and she wasn't awake yet.

When she saw the caller ID, she even smiled, swiped to answer, and called out in a slightly hoarse voice: "Wifey~"

"Liang Shi, are you crazy?" Xu Qingzhu's voice directly drowned out Liang Shi's "wifey," carrying a cold and harsh interrogation.

"Why did you kill me?" Xu Qingzhu demanded again.

The sleepiness on Liang Shi's end instantly vanished. She opened her eyes, though her just-woken voice sounded clear and crisp: "Babe, what's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu was stunned upon hearing this.

Liang Shi asked anxiously: "Wifey, are you in danger over there?"

Xu Qingzhu sat on the bed, sunlight streaming into the room, falling right upon her.

She ran her hand through her hair in confusion and asked, bewildered: "What's wrong with me?"